

Chapter 65 - Chu An'an

Since yesterday, Yan Lin had been handling the acquisition of Wang Group. Although Wang Group had been declining in recent years, a starving camel is still bigger than a horse¹, so dealing with their affairs was quite tedious.

Fortunately, this time Yan Lin wasn't the only one targeting Wang Group - Qian Yaozu, who loved his daughter dearly, was also joining forces with Yan Lin.

Mo Yixu knew that Yan Lin had barely closed her eyes for the past two days, so when taking away the last document, he said with concern: "President Yan, there's nothing left today. Why don't you go home and rest?"

Yan Lin closed her eyes and leaned back in her chair. Hearing Mo Yixu's voice, she straightened up again. She didn't answer his question but asked instead: "What time is it?"

Mo Yixu looked at the wall clock. "Three twenty."

"I remember Cat Station Video's awards banquet starts at six, right?"

"Yes." Mo Yixu nodded. "Are you planning to attend?"

As soon as Mo Yixu asked, he knew it was a stupid question. If he remembered correctly, Miss Feng was a Cat Station Video blogger, and she would definitely be at today's carnival.

It was all because there had been too many things recently - he had almost forgotten about this.

So Mo Yixu saw Yan Lin nod. "You've worked hard these past two days. Go home and rest after you finish. Just have Chang Ya accompany me tonight."

Chang Ya was also a member of the CEO's office, a decisive woman who, along with Mo Yixu, was considered Yan Lin's right-hand person. However, Chang Ya often handled company affairs, while Mo Yixu, as the special assistant, followed Yan Lin year-round.

Mo Yixu was naturally happy to have this rare break.

"Alright, I'll notify her. Shall I arrange a car for four o'clock?"

Yan Lin nodded. "I'll sleep in the rest room for a while. Just wake me when it's time."

"Yes, President Yan. Rest well. I'll head out first."

After Mo Yixu left, Yan Lin finally showed her fatigue, raising both hands to rub her throbbing temples before getting up and heading to the rest room.

She needed to rest well - at least she needed to be in good condition before seeing A Yue.

Feng Yue and Xu Yan were being led to the VIP room, but when passing by an adjacent makeup room, Feng Yue suddenly stopped in her tracks.

The door to this makeup room was half open, probably for the convenience of those inside. There was a woman inside getting her makeup done, with her back to the door. However, Feng Yue could see her face clearly in the mirror in front of her.

That delicate, lovely little face was one Feng Yue could never forget.

Why was she here? How could she be here?

Feng Yue stood frozen in place, her mind filled with chaotic thoughts. Qian He, walking behind her, saw her standing motionless and thought Feng Yue had forgotten something. "Little Yue, what's wrong? Did you forget something?"

Qian He's voice pulled Feng Yue back from her daze. She casually curved her lips and shook her head. "No, I just thought of something. Let's go."

Qian He didn't suspect anything. But as Feng Yue continued walking forward, she couldn't help but glance once more at the person in that makeup room.

Those eyebrows, that smile - she couldn't be mistaken.

That face could only belong to Chu An'an.

In "The Past of An and Lin"², Chu An'an was connected to Feng Yue's death, which made it impossible for Feng Yue not to care about her presence.

She didn't know what Chu An'an's appearance here meant, nor did she know whether the power of the plot would still make her die as written in the book.

She was afraid, and she was reluctant to let go.

So when the makeup artist was doing her makeup, she couldn't help but inquire.

"Andy, I see your studio is very busy today." Feng Yue asked casually.

This makeup artist named Andy was one of the partners of this studio, and Feng Yue was a regular customer.

"Yes, we've been busy since this morning. Some of the girls outside haven't even had a grain of rice yet." Andy frowned - this was the trouble with good business.

"Are there any other events today besides the carnival at the convention center?"

Andy shook her head. "No, everyone who came to our studio today is going to the carnival. I haven't heard of any other events."

"Oh, I see. They should all be bloggers then. I even saw a few familiar faces earlier," Feng Yue said.

Andy stood behind Feng Yue curling her hair. "Right, most of them are bloggers, but there are also a few idols. I heard they were invited to perform at tonight's banquet."

"Idols? Is the one getting makeup next door also one? I don't find her very familiar."

Andy laughed. "The one next door is the C-position winner from that really popular talent show recently. I think her name is Chu An'an? She's not even twenty years old yet. It's normal that you don't find her familiar."

Hearing this, Feng Yue smiled and turned to chat about other topics. She remembered indeed seeing this passage in the book.

Chu An'an debuted through a talent show and was popular for a while, but later she apparently had a falling out with her management company and was shelved for some time. When she returned to the public eye, she had already transitioned to being an actress.

She met Yan Lin when her acting career was flourishing.

Now, it seemed this was during the time when Chu An'an had just debuted.

Feng Yue sorted out her thoughts, and her heart wasn't as tense anymore. Chu An'an's current experiences were still similar to what was written in the book, without any major deviations.

So Chu An'an appearing here was reasonable - she was the one who shouldn't be appearing here.

Before long, Feng Yue and Xu Yan's styling was finished. Both disliked complications, so their styling was the most simple and clean.

They didn't seek to compete with others in glamour, just needed to look passable on camera.

Feng Yue's dress was brought from home, while Xu Yan, being extremely lazy, just picked one randomly at the studio.

Feng Yue wore a pure black satin long dress. The off-shoulder neckline perfectly exposed her superior shoulder and neck lines and collarbones, with puffy sleeves revealing fair, slender arms underneath.

The fitted, body-hugging design showcased her figure's curves to perfection, but the most eye-catching feature was the hollow design at the back waist. Her exposed lower back was playfully hidden and revealed under a pure white bow, looking simple yet detailed everywhere.

Feng Yue's long hair was curled into big waves by Andy, then tied up with a hair tie and fixed into a low bun, with a white bow that matched the dress's bow pinned on top.

Xu Yan's dress was also black, with a deep V neckline that complemented the clean, sharp long sleeves. Silver-white buttons decorated from the V-neck all the way to her left hip, and the dress's slit went up to her thigh, looking both handsome and alluring.

Qian He was very satisfied with both their looks, so she pulled Andy to take many photos of the three of them.

When the three headed back to the convention center, it was almost six o'clock. The staff responsible for them brought them to the rest room to wait for the red carpet to start promptly at six.

Since Xu Yan and Feng Yue knew each other, the planners arranged for them to walk the red carpet together, so naturally they were resting in the same room.

However, because Cat Station Video had many bloggers, it was impossible for just two bloggers to use one rest room. Before they had stayed long, several people came in one after another from outside.

Everyone who entered was dressed to the nines, wearing no fewer than three colors. This made Feng Yue and Xu Yan seem somewhat out of place.

Having seen countless beauties in her life, Qian He leaned close to whisper in their ears: "I guarantee with my eyes that have seen so many beauties that you two will definitely stand out in this roomful of people!"

Feng Yue smiled helplessly, while Xu Yan started bantering back and forth with Qian He.

Feng Yue ignored them and stood up to go to the restroom.

The venue was large, and the restroom was quite far from the rest room, so Feng Yue asked for directions as she walked, eventually ending up somewhere she didn't recognize.

There were more and more staff here, and Feng Yue even saw several celebrities being escorted forward by staff members.

Feng Yue turned a corner and finally saw a restroom sign ahead. She breathed a sigh of relief and was about to walk forward when she saw Yan Lin coming out of the restroom.

Feng Yue stood behind her. Yan Lin was washing her hands and didn't see her. Feng Yue was still frozen in place, not knowing whether to go or not, when she saw another person come out of the restroom.

Chu An'an wore a glittery stage outfit with a thick coat over it. Perhaps because she was wearing too many layers, she wasn't paying attention to her footing.

The restroom floor was naturally slippery, and she had just walked out when her foot slipped and she was about to fall forward onto the ground.

Yan Lin, who was washing her hands at the sink, instinctively reached out with both hands, and Chu An'an fell straight into Yan Lin's arms.

Chu An'an was obviously startled and gripped tightly onto the front of Yan Lin's coat.

"Are you alright?" Yan Lin's cool voice sounded, and only then did Chu An'an come to her senses, quickly standing up from this kind person.

"I'm sorry, I slipped just now. Thank you for catching me, thank you." Chu An'an thanked her repeatedly.

If she had fallen like that today, it might have affected her performance later.

"It was nothing." After saying this, Yan Lin prepared to turn and leave.

It was then that she saw Feng Yue standing not far away.

Feng Yue stood frozen in place, her whole body trembling uncontrollably as if she had been soaked in ice water.

She clearly realized that the book was issuing her a death warning.

No matter how she struggled, no matter how she sought to survive, what was meant to happen in the book would definitely happen.

The meeting between Chu An'an and Yan Lin was like this, and so would her own death.

She had naively thought that as long as she could control her condition, as long as she worked hard to survive, everything might change.

And indeed it had seemed so - the plot of the book had changed, and she had even seen that it was completely blank last time. But the ending would not change.

She clearly remembered that the first meeting between Yan Lin and Chu An'an was supposed to be four years later, but now, perhaps due to the butterfly effect brought by her rebirth, they had met four years early.

Since the outcome of their meeting wouldn't change, then her destined death would also arrive as scheduled.

Author's Note: According to Yue Yue's logic, she's right - as a supporting character, she can't change the book's ending. But Yan Lin has also been reborn, which means one of the main characters in the book will no longer follow the book's plot, which is why the book she saw the second time was blank.

Footnotes:

1. **"A starving camel is still bigger than a horse" (瘦死的骆驼比马大):** A Chinese idiom meaning that even when something powerful has declined, it's still more formidable than something that was never as strong to begin with.
2. **"The Past of An and Lin" (《安霖往事》):** This is the title of the novel that Feng Yue discovered she was living in. "An" refers to Chu An'an and "Lin" refers to Yan Lin.